

Rep. Tom Emmer on Hot Talk with the Ox

KNSI

Broadcast: 2026-04-22 • Duration: 15:50

****HOST:**

** Kicking things off, our host, Congressman Tom Emmer, The Whip. Thanks for having us, sir. And what's with the toes sticking out of your sock there?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah, no, Ox, it's great to have you back. It's good to be here. It's great to have you back, and you are honorary Whip for a day. You have joined the Whip team for the day, so glad to have you. Yes, you are pointing out that I'm rolling around on a scooter and I have my right leg, lower leg, ankle wrapped up. It's an ongoing thing, but I actually tell people, you know, they call this the Whip job, but I think I've been kicking people in the butt so much I've got to have my feet repaired. So, yeah, it's just a, it's an ongoing saga. But I will tell you, I ran a marathon for the first time in my life in May.

****OX:**

** Serves you right. A marathon?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** I did.

****OX:**

** You should have a sore foot then.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** 26.2 miles. We don't have enough time for me to tell you that story.

****OX:**

** Oh, my goodness. My feet hurt just listening to it. But back to work here. We're kind of kicking off a fun show. This is an annual thing that I travel with the St. Cloud Area Chamber of Commerce folks. One of my many trips here throughout the year, but this is kind of fun. And I know the folks are coming in this afternoon, Tom.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah, I'm looking forward to seeing them. It's interesting times in Minnesota. People are waking up to the negligent, poor leadership. And I think people, elected officials, better start picking a side in this thing. You're not going to be allowed to be on both sides of every issue, which politicians, this is what is frustrating the voting public, whether they're left of center or right of center, not the extremes. The extremes, you're just not going to convince of anything. But the reasonable Minnesotans are waking up to the fact that, wait a second, you know, Amy Klobuchar, she said she was with us when it came to mining. She was given an opportunity to vote for

mining in northern Minnesota, and she voted against them. So it's time. The public's sick and tired of people who are everything to everyone. They want people to be honest with them and tell them exactly what it is they stand for and what they're willing to do so that they can make an educated choice. And you'll see more and more Minnesotans. I think central Minnesota is a great example. Because I think central Minnesota, I heard from more people in our district saying, please thank President Trump for the going after the illegals, the rapists, the murderers, the pedophiles, the drug dealers. Thanks for finding those migrant children. Were they all happy with the methods that were used? No, no. They were concerned about some of the methods that were used, and they had questions. But the overwhelming response from central Minnesota, which we represent, was thank the president.

****OX:**

**** Absolutely.** And to that point, then, all the things that Trump has been doing, the things that we've wanted done, he hit the ground running. He keeps doing things. It's shocking because we're not used to this. We are bombarded in the press by all the stuff that he's doing. But every time I come to Washington, it amazes me. Guess what? There's other business going on here. You're all not totally obsessed with every word out of Donald Trump's mouth like the rest of us are. How much of a distraction is Donald Trump on your day-to-day workings here in Washington?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

**** Well,** keep in mind, we in Minnesota are not focused on everything that Donald Trump says and does. Our press has Trump derangement syndrome, especially that worthless paper in the Twin Cities. Those guys, I swear, I don't know that that paper is good for even a dog kennel at this point. It's just not worth it. There is so much going on. If people would just get over their hatred, if people would just get past their derangement when it comes to this president, they would recognize if you strip the name away, amazing tax reform has been done. They would recognize that, was it all perfect? No. But the waste, fraud, and abuse that they've rooted out in a little over a year is nothing short of miraculous. The changes that are going on here in Washington, D.C., just with the representatives, the senators, I mean, you've got a major change going on in this country. I think much like we probably saw when you and I would be very young back in the late 60s, much as people would have seen back in the 30s, you pick your time in history where there was a major upheaval and change. I think we're in one of those great periods, it's very divisive. But the good news is, what a country to have this because you know what happens? When we come out of it, Ox, we're better than we were before.

****OX:**

**** Exactly.** Yeah, this is an investment in the future, no question. And then to that point, you know, I was talking to the cab driver on the way over, right? I said, you know, when Trump got elected, I thought things were going to get cheaper. I thought gas was going to go down. I thought it was going to, it's like so far it's gotten more expensive. It's like, yeah, but like we're a year into this whole thing.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

**** It hasn't gotten more expensive.** We still haven't reached the high that Joe Biden and Kamala Harris created. We're still a buck or two away from that, depending on where you are. But yes, has it gone up since Donald Trump made it go down? Yeah, it's gone up. And that's because of the reliance, the world reliance on this world market for energy, which I would argue in some cases has been detrimental to the American energy industry. Look, if Western Europe has a, what, 60, 70 percent reliance on energy coming through the Hormuz Strait, that's a problem, Ox. That's a problem. I, if President Trump has made it clear, buy U.S. We've got plenty. We're, we're ready to sell it to you. Let's keep this thing going. And the, the Iran, the Iranian conflict, I commend

the president. And I, I'm not a every wars guy by any means. But this president is using the military appropriately. I, at some point he's going to resolve this, this Iranian conflict. I mean, basically what we have right now is the mullahs want a deal and the Royal Guard does not. So you, and they've, they've eliminated so many of the, the, what, strong men that ran Iran. Now you don't know who the leader is, right? At this point, it's the people in Iran that matter. It's the safety and security of not just that region, but the world. Remember two weeks before this mission started, Ox, the Iranian regime was telling the world they didn't have long range capability. And literally during this conflict, they rolled out two ballistic missiles that can travel 2,500 miles in an attempt to hit an American air base a long ways away. Those missiles, by the way, can hit all of Western Europe. They could hit London from where they were. So this is a serious thing. And I don't believe our president will stop, which is why prices will probably stay right about where they are, might fluctuate a little bit until this gets resolved. And it will get resolved when the US takes that enriched uranium that the Iranians possess right now. They are never going to have a nuclear weapon. That is the red line.

****OX:**

** Amen to that. Congressman Tom Emmer hosting us here at the US Capitol for a hot talk with the Ox. Going back home, we're here. You represent the 6th, of course, in central Minnesota, kind of. A couple other people in Minnesota, Ilhan Omar. Is Elk River in your district?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Oh, yeah. Elk River. I'm so proud of those guys. They've got the flag thing going on. Well, I'm glad that they finally recognized. I mean, everybody wants to point at Tim Walz. It's the Somali flag. Tim Walz and Peggy Flanagan and these radical, woke, left-wing, anarchist Democrats in Minneapolis literally changed our state flag to resemble a foreign country flag. We are not the country of Somalia. If you want to be in Somalia, get the hell out of here and go back to Somalia. All right? You're here. Minnesota. Proud of Elk River. They said no. The flag that we had for, oh, so many years reflects our history much better than this nonsense that these guys put out.

****OX:**

** Yeah. God bless Elk River. I want to move there. Also, Ilhan Omar is making some news. Interesting, the whole campaign finance thing. There's a lot of my listeners. We hear about, oh, Ox, yeah, they always say they're going to do this and say they're going to do that. When is somebody going to finally arrest people like this? Are we approaching some criminal charges with Ilhan Omar? Are we finally going to get to the truth of her background and how she got here and her financing?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, number one, the number one question I get from Minnesotans that I represent and Minnesotans that I just know from across the state is when is someone going to be held accountable for the bad things that they've been doing, breaking the laws? In this case, whether we talk about Tim Walz or we talk about Keith Ellison or we talk about this worthless prosecutor, cop-hating Mary Moriarty in Hennepin County, it seems to be a theme. But Ilhan takes the cake on all of them. Ilhan Omar is a corrupt, fraud-enabling, racist anti-Semite like we have never seen. And the current scandal, which has been out there for a while, I mean, we file financial disclosures as representatives in the U.S. House of Representatives every Congress. We disclose what our interests are because people want to make sure that you're on the up and up, that you're literally not conflicted when you're making decisions and taking votes. Ilhan Omar filed one at the end of last year that showed that she had a 3,500 percent increase in wealth from the one she filed two years earlier. She literally, her financial disclosure indicated she had gone from a net worth of roughly \$65,000 to a net worth of \$30 million in two years. Now,

okay, she filed it. I was talking to the White House at the end of the last year asking, hopefully someone's investigating this because this doesn't just happen. Her husband's winery that he was getting sued by investors for misrepresenting the investment that was upside down is now suddenly flush with money. Money's coming through his so-called consulting business. These people have all this cash. She's working with Somali fraudsters at home. Follow that money. We don't know where that went. Well, we know where a lot of it went. Went to BMWs, Mercedes, property, trips, etc. But guess what? That thing is out there for months, saying she's worth \$30 million. This week, she filed an amended disclosure, eye popping. She files an amended disclosure that suggests, oh, that was just an accounting error, Ox. I'm actually worth slightly less than \$100,000. I mean, a multi-million dollar accounting mistake? Listen, either the accountant she was using is a graduate of the Learing Center, or she is incompetent and or at worst, corrupt. If Ilhan Omar, and I celebrate all of the ethics investigations that they're doing on her, whether it's coming from the administration, or you're not going to get it from Minnesota, or other independent groups, and more importantly, the members in Congress. If that girl has found to have benefited in any way or participated in any way in this fraud, she should be held to the highest accountability the law provides. And by the way, that includes marriage fraud. If it is finally confirmed that someone in her capacity committed marriage fraud to gain or help someone gain citizenship in this country, they should be denaturalized and shipped back to where they came from.

****OX:**

** Immediately. Yes. Congressman, before we go, we have a unique opportunity here to be in the WHIP office in a minute or so. For those who don't know, what exactly does the WHIP do? What do you do logistically?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** So it's a great question because people don't know the answers to these questions and they think everybody else does. The Speaker's in charge of everything on the campus, security, office space, the agenda, etc. The majority leader, number two, is responsible for the calendar and scheduling the floor, right? Working with chairs on when things are ready to come to the floor. The WHIP's job is the best job in Congress. Why? Because we work with every single member and when the Speaker makes a play call and the leader wants to schedule something for the floor, it's our job to tell them what our members will and won't do, what they can and can't do. And then if it comes to the floor, it's our job to get it passed. And I mean, we have succeeded time and time again, perhaps even more with one or two or three extra votes than a Republican majority that I was here for several years ago that had 247 members. Didn't accomplish anything like we have accomplished in this Congress. So it's a great job, man. And Majority WHIP is the key.

****OX:**

** Any worry about the Virginia vote yesterday?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah, I don't like the Virginia vote. I don't like relying on the courts, especially when you look at the fact that they have violated, they being the people that wanted this redistricting, have literally the Democrat majority and Abigail Spanberger, who was just elected their governor, by the way, she is Tim Walz in a dress, believe me. And the public knows it, but it was a little too late in terms of the vote. It was less than 100,000 votes that decided that last night. Very dishonest ballot question, much like Gavin Newsom did in California. But here's the issue. They violated their own Constitution every step of the way to have this vote last night. And the Virginia Supreme Court says, oh, we're not going to weigh in until after the vote. Why would you wait? Why would you wait unless you're using that as an excuse? The only hope I have with the court now is that they violated their state constitution and perhaps the U.S. Supreme Court has jurisdiction because of that. Because the U.S.

Supreme Court will typically stay out of state election fights because the state is responsible for running its own elections. Unless it involves a federal issue, like Minnesota's dealing with this right now, right? Steve Simon's been asked to produce all of his homework. All the voting rolls, all the voting records, because the federal government wants to do an audit and make sure that the federal elections that Minnesota has administered over the last several cycles was in fact fair, open, and transparent. And guess what? Steve Simon's refusing to provide that homework. Ox, it's kind of the same thing. These guys don't respect the courts. They use them to delay, but they don't respect their decisions. I hope Virginia sees some type of court involvement that corrects a very unjust result. But if it doesn't, it makes our job a little bit more difficult going into the midterm, but still very doable.

****OX:**

** Congressman Emmer, thank you. Thanks for hosting us today. Looking forward to meeting some of your friends.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Alright, Ox. Enjoy the visit. I don't see any transcript segment provided in your message. You mentioned there should be a transcript segment between the speaker labels and the instructions, but that section appears to be empty. Could you please provide the actual transcript text that you'd like me to add speaker labels to? Once you share the transcript segment, I'll be happy to add the appropriate speaker labels (**HOST, **OX, **REP. TOM EMMER) while preserving all the original text exactly as specified.

This transcript was independently produced by MN-06 Watch for accountability and archival purposes.

Source: KNSI (2026-04-22)

Archived: April 22, 2026

Source URL: <https://youtu.be/btLz5t4eflw>

For questions or corrections: mn06watch@gmail.com